AEP FROM ZERO • PART 3 • PROVE WHAT WORKED (CJA)

EPISODE 25

Customer Journey Analytics Tutorial: Person ID

What is Customer Journey Analytics (CJA), and why can its numbers differ from Adobe Experience Platform profiles? This beginner CJA tutorial explains how CJA reads data lake datasets through a connection, what person-based, dataset-based and retroactive mean, and how to set up a CJA connection with event, profile and lookup datasets joined through a key and a matching key. You will learn how to choose a CJA person ID that is case sensitive and matches across datasets, how CJA

Previously: three teams, three numbers

- Last time: a broken journey triaged with step events
- Two weeks into the relaunch: three teams, three numbers
- Each counted rows in its own system, its own way
- Rohan's rule: one pipe, one person, then the number
- Today: Customer Journey Analytics and the person ID

KEY IDEA

Two weeks into the relaunch, three teams bring Anjali three different order counts. Act Three starts by building one pipe with one definition of a person.

What is Customer Journey Analytics?

- A separate application, not reporting inside AEP
- Reads datasets from the data lake, the archive
- Not the profile store, the receptionist
- Datasets, connection, data view, Workspace
- Menu: Workspace, Data Management, Components, Tools, Labs

KEY IDEA

CJA is a separate application. It reads datasets from the AEP data lake through a connection, not from the profile store.

Why analyst and marketer can both be right

Compare	Profile store	CJA
Reads	One merged, current person	Lake datasets, with history
Who is one person	Identity graph, merge policy	Person ID in the connection
Serves	Activation	Measurement

KEY IDEA

Profile stitching serves activation; analytical stitching serves measurement. Different rules and time spans give different counts for defensible reasons.

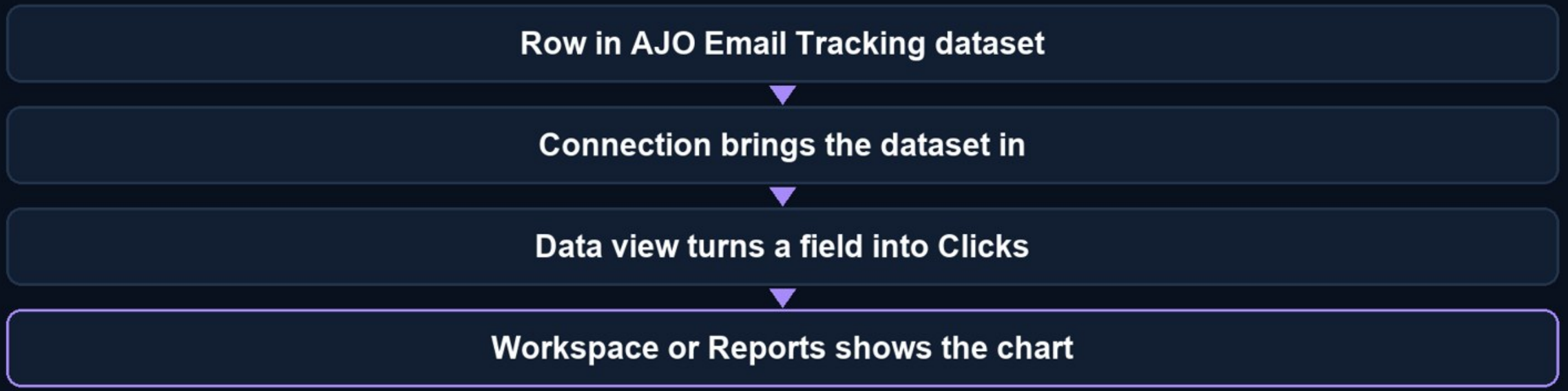
Person-based, dataset-based, retroactive

Word	Bloom example
Person-based	Priya's phone and laptop: one person
Dataset-based	Web, orders, journeys and catalogue
Retroactive	Fix a definition, past data follows

KEY IDEA

Three words describe CJA: it counts people, it joins any dataset in the lake, and it applies definitions at report time, so past data follows a fix.

Follow one number from a click to a chart



KEY IDEA

Every CJA number has the same path: a row in a dataset, a connection, a data view, then Workspace. Walk a suspicious number back through those layers.

Bloom 360: four kinds of dataset

Bloom dataset	Type in Bloom 360	Needs a person ID?
Bloom Web Events	Event	Yes
Bloom Orders	Event	Yes
Journey Step Events	Event	Yes
Bloom Customers	Profile	Yes
Product catalogue	Lookup	No: key and matching key

KEY IDEA

A connection holds event, profile, lookup and summary datasets. Bloom 360 has three event datasets, one profile dataset and one lookup.

The lookup: key and matching key

- Catalogue: 200 products, loaded as a batch dataset
- A lookup needs no person ID
- Key: the SKU column in the catalogue
- Matching key: the SKU on each event's product line
- Result: product names and categories in reports

KEY IDEA

Farhan loads the 200-product catalogue as a batch dataset. As a lookup it needs no person ID, only a key and a matching key on the SKU.

What is a person ID, and why does it matter?

- Person ID: the field that says which rows are one human
- Chosen per dataset when you build a connection
- Case sensitive: abc123 and ABC123 are two people
- A row with no value is skipped
- Datasets merge only when person IDs match

KEY IDEA

The person ID decides which rows are one human. It is chosen per dataset, it is case sensitive, rows without it are skipped, and it must match across datasets.

Bloom's choice: the email on every dataset

Dataset	Person ID in Bloom 360
Bloom Orders	orderEmail, not BloomID
Bloom Customers	The profile's email
Journey Step Events	The email
Bloom Web Events	Stitching gives ECID rows the email

KEY IDEA

Bloom 360 uses the email as the person ID everywhere: orderEmail on orders, the profile's email, and stitching gives anonymous web rows the email.

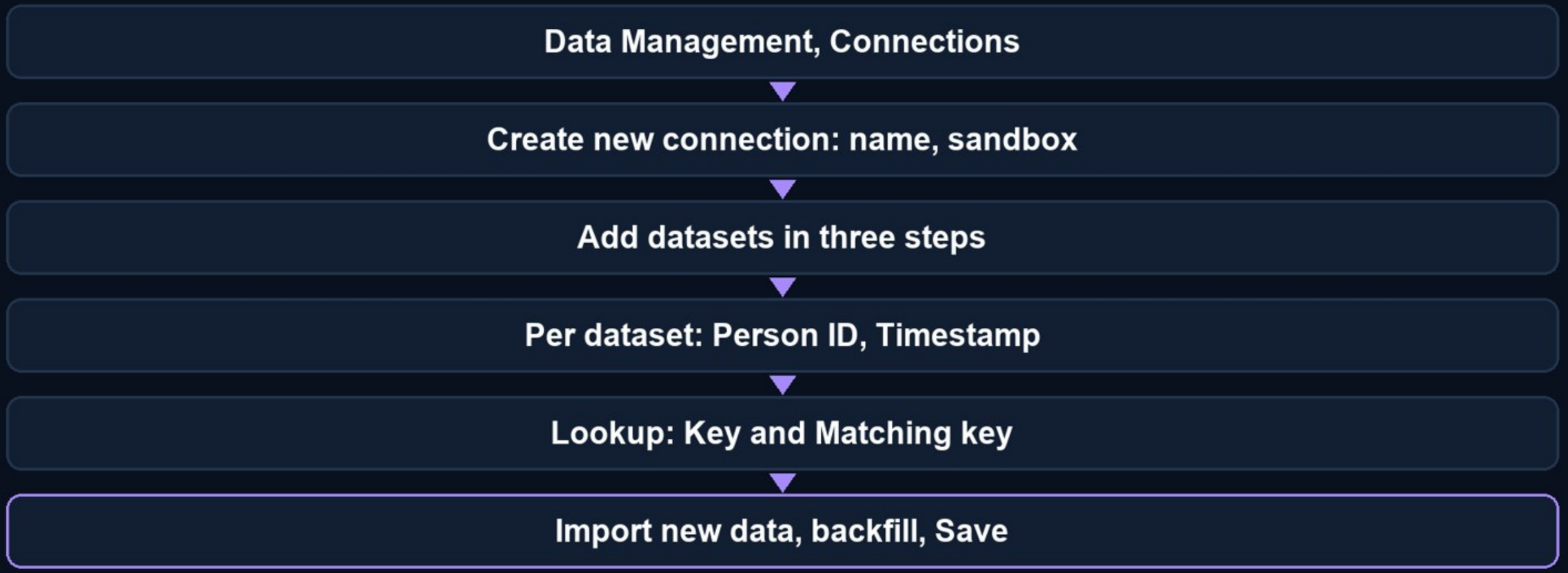
Tracing Priya with stitching off and on

Priya's evening	Stitching off	Stitching on
7:44 PM add-to-cart, ECID	Anonymous person	Priya, by email
7:52 PM order, email	A second person	Priya, by email
People counted	Two	One
Cart abandoners	One, and it is false	None

KEY IDEA

Without stitching, Priya's anonymous add-to-cart and her known order are two people and one false abandon. With stitching, she is one buyer.

Building Bloom 360, screen by screen



KEY IDEA

Data Management, Connections, Create new connection. Settings, then Add datasets in three steps, then person ID, timestamp, stitching, key and Save.

Records skipped, the window, and Rohan's count

- Details page: Records added, skipped, deleted
- Skipped: no timestamp, or missing or invalid person ID
- Rolling data window: 13 months
- Backfills: up to 7 days small, 30 days large
- Rohan's answer: a count of people, not rows

KEY IDEA

Records skipped counts rows with no timestamp or an invalid person ID. Bloom 360 keeps a rolling 13 months, and finally counts people, not rows.

Why don't AJO reports and CJA numbers match?

Reason	What it means
Retries	AJO counts them; CJA does not
Time zone	AJO reports in UTC; a data view may not
Late feedback	Delivery data up to 2 hours late
Latency	CJA: 90 minutes, 4 hours with stitching

KEY IDEA

Adobe says the gap is typically under one to two percent: AJO counts retries, reports in UTC, and delivery data arrives up to two hours late.

Use in CJA is a billing decision

- Use in CJA: each row counts toward licensed rows
- Switching it off later still bills the full month
- The organisation owner's decision, never a learner's
- Edit Connection is a live form: leave with Cancel
- Practise by reading: look, screenshot, leave

KEY IDEA

Use in CJA makes each row count toward monthly licensed rows, and switching it off still bills the full month. It is the owner's decision.

Interview corner

- CJA is person-based, dataset-based and retroactive
- Wrong person ID: confident, wrong numbers
- One shared identity, cleaned before it lands
- Stitching for anonymous web rows
- Explain AJO versus CJA gaps calmly

KEY IDEA

CJA is person-based, dataset-based and retroactive. A connection with the wrong person ID produces confident, wrong numbers.

Recap, your question, and next time

- CJA reads the lake through a connection
- Event, profile and lookup datasets in Bloom 360
- Person ID: case sensitive, must match, else skipped
- Use in CJA bills rows: the owner decides
- Next: data views and derived fields

KEY IDEA

CJA reads the lake through a connection; the person ID must match; Use in CJA bills rows. Next: data views and derived fields.